

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting - November 3rd, 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ENjPnAKBULA
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Delaware County Commissioners Regular Meeting Report

Meeting Date: November 3, 2025

Time: 9:00 AM

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or committee work session was held prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the regular meeting at [00:04:34](#) on Monday, November 3rd, explicitly identifying the board.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Commissioner Reett (referred to as Reagan/Reett in roll calls), Commissioner Brand (referred to as Ban/Brand), Commissioner Henry, and Mr. Brook (Attorney/Staff).

- **Members Absent:** None.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named by title in the opening transcript, but led by the board president/chair.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance led at [00:04:36](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **Item Identifier & Title:** [00:22:44](#) Approval of Minutes from October 20th.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Motion to table approved by Roll Call (Commissioner Reagan: yes, Commissioner Brand: yes).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:05:13](#) **Petition to Schedule Hearing for Bridge Vacations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ed (County Staff).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding two dead-end bridge locations where the county holds right-of-way ownership rather than fee simple ownership. The best legal path is via the road vacation process. Includes Bridge #507 (1000 block of East Wade, Muncie) and Bridge #190 over No-Name Creek (County Road 200 West, north of 400 South). Public hearings and first reading of the ordinance will take place on November 17th.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve petition passed by Roll Call (Commissioner Reett: yes, Commissioner Brand: yes, Commissioner Henry: yes).
- [00:11:49](#) **BW Facility Maintenance Agreement (Tabled Business)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Ed.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Agreement removed from the table because the direction of the new addiction recovery center changed; a lease with Muncie OPC LLC was approved making them responsible for maintenance via a triple net agreement.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to remove from table passed by roll call; subsequent motion to withdraw request passed by Roll Call (Commissioner Brand: yes, Commissioner Reett: yes).
- [00:12:43](#) **Lean Assist Program Master Agreement (Tabled Business)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ed and Mr. Pope (County Treasurer).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Centralized data system for managing property tax liens across municipal entities (e.g., Muncie Sanitary, Albany, Daleville) and the county treasurer/auditor to resolve communication issues and prevent delayed lien

removals. A \$5 fee will be added to delinquent tax bills via future ordinance (no cost to the county or taxing units).

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to remove from table and adopt Master Agreement passed by Roll Call (Commissioner Reagan: yes, Commissioner Brand: yes, Commissioner Henry: yes).
- **00:22:58 Ordinance 2021-032: Review of Employee Firearm Carry**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Research into whether county employees can carry firearms on the job revealed an existing 2021 ordinance outlining rules, definitions, and requirements (including valid license/statutory compliance and department head/elected official written permission). No new legislative action was necessary as the framework already exists.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational review only; no vote taken.
- **00:27:58 State Health Department Injury Prevention Grant**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jamie Bane (Health Department Administrator).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Application submitted for a \$10,000 reimbursable state grant (deadline November 1st) to expand the Safe Sleep program (with Purdue Extension) and renew the aquatic safety/swim lessons program (with the YMCA). Supplemented by \$6,000 from an existing cooperative agreement grant fund.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Commissioner Reagan: yes, Commissioner Brand: yes).
- **00:28:08 Thoroughfare Plan Relief: Ashton Land Surveyors**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kathy Van Ice (Ashton Land Surveyors).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for relief from thoroughfare plan right-of-way dedication for two residential parcels dividing off for Rosalie Patton (1221 East Jackson Street). Existing pre-placed structures sit close to the highway, and INDOT already owns substantial right-of-way.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve relief request passed by Roll Call (Commissioner Brand: yes, Commissioner Reett: yes).
- **00:30:53 Delaware County IT Assessment Proposal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Staltz (LEAP) / Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal for LEAP to conduct a free IT infrastructure assessment (\$5,000 value credited to zero cost) to evaluate the network ahead of upcoming retirement changes for current IT support.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Commissioner Brand: yes, Commissioner Henry: yes).

- **00:33:19 Legislative Impact Analysis Proposal & Baker Tilly Contracts**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Reett / Auditor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Initial proposal to hire Baker Tilly for a parcel-level property tax impact analysis of Senate Enrolled Act No. 1 was tabled **00:35:10** and later withdrawn **00:39:38** because the scope was already covered under the broader annual Baker Tilly county contract/audit agreement. A comprehensive Baker Tilly annual contract (including potential add-on analyses up to a high-end total of \$115,000 budgeted by the auditor) was presented.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Baker Tilly contract approved by Roll Call (Commissioner Brand: yes, Commissioner Reett: yes). Separate motion to withdraw the standalone impact analysis request passed by Roll Call (Commissioner Reett: yes, Commissioner Brand: yes, Commissioner Henry: yes).
- **00:40:00 Muncie Sanitary District Interlocal Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ed / County Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Interlocal agreement for “pump-and-haul” maintenance services for the justice center’s grinder pit/wet well (“muffin monster”). Reduces quarterly maintenance costs from \$2,500 per incident down to \$1,000 per incident when services are required on call.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Commissioner Reett: yes, Commissioner Brand: yes, Commissioner Henry: yes).
- **00:42:28 Ordinance: County Firearms Training Range Fee Structure (Second Reading)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Second reading of an ordinance establishing user fees for the sheriff-administered shooting range located by the highway department.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by Roll Call (Commissioner Brand: yes, Commissioner Reagan: yes).
- **00:43:12 Ordinance 025-24: New Pond Management Ordinance (Second Reading)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kylene Swackmer (Plan Commission).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Second reading of a new ordinance regulating safe pond development, setbacks, depth, vegetation, decommissioning fees, inspections, and enforcement. Pre-existing ponds are deemed legally non-conforming provided they maintain current standards unless expanded by over 1,000 square feet. Codified under County Code Title 3, Chapter 24.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by Roll Call (Commissioner Brand: yes, Commissioner Reagan: yes, Commissioner Henry: yes).
- **00:47:24 Adoption of County Investment Policy**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Legal Counsel.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Final confirmation that the investment policy adopted provisionally at the previous meeting has successfully cleared legal review.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Acknowledged and finalized without objection.
- **00:55:42 Payment of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** General claims totaling **\$3,008,528.67** reviewed, featuring highlights on SRRI contracts, inmate medical/meals, Youth Opportunity Center billing, fuel, Brooks Paving (split 50% MVH / 50% CCMG at \$490,975.75), TIF allocations, workers' comp, tax sales, and riverboat wagering revenues. Credit card statements remain under board review for compliance.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Commissioner Brand: yes, Commissioner Henry: yes).
- **00:59:54 Payment of ARP Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** ARP claims totaling **\$15,600.10**, including admin/legal (\$7,860) and RQAW claims for Bridge 51 over Kilbuck (\$7,740.75).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Commissioner Reagan: yes, Commissioner Henry: yes).
- **01:01:30 Payment of Payroll**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Payroll claims totaling **\$1,016,084.90** for the period ending 10/22/2025.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Commissioner Brand: yes, Commissioner Reagan: yes).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:01:59 Sunny Matters (Second Harvest Food Bank):** Highlighted an urgent food insecurity crisis affecting over 25,000 neighbors in East Central Indiana and 7,000 in Delaware County, exacerbated by potential SNAP benefit suspensions due to federal government shutdowns and unpaid federal workers. Urged community support, cash donations (noting high buying efficiency of \$5 = 20 meals), and volunteer sign-ups via www.curehunger.org.
- **01:08:14 Jerry Wade (Resident, 801 West Carson):** Addressed previous commissioner comments regarding open carry for county employees. Spoke from a background as a

combat veteran, weapons instructor, and Ball State peace/conflict research fellow, emphasizing that untrained open carry increases liability and conflict risks, and any employees carrying on duty should undergo rigorous police-level training.

- **[01:02:37 / 01:12:37] Ricky (Newsman and Author):** Discussed community impacts of the federal shutdown, property tax cycles, and urged fiscal restraint by local government rather than heavy spending on outside consultants like Baker Tilly.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Human Resources (Josh Jarvis):** Flu shots available through the Health Clinic or IU Health; a new return-to-work policy took effect November 1st; monthly newsletters and weekly inspiration emails will be distributed.
 - **Highway Department (Carrie D):** Addressed a damaged neighborhood column in Dice Acres (estimated at \$13,700), confirming it is not county property and insurance claims should follow the responsible vehicle driver; noted ongoing culvert/roadwork operations on Stockport/Jackson.
 - **Veterans Service Office (Brian Wilson):** Recapped the Battle Mind to Home Summit and announced upcoming weekend events: the Warrior Walk at Muncie Central track and a Veteran Celebration Freedom Tribute at First Baptist Church.
 - **Buildings & Grounds (Don Chambers):** Noted ongoing cost reductions on HVAC air filters (saving ~\$2,000 quarterly) and housekeeping supply reviews. Dave Hill, a long-serving employee of 37<U+2013>38 years, was recognized upon his retirement.
 - **Commissioner Reett:** Highlighted upcoming participation in a nuclear summit at Purdue University and meetings with the governor's office regarding local energy/infrastructure; noted a telephone audit revealing 48 unused desk phones and ~130 minimally used lines, targeting a \$20,000 annual savings.
- **Adjournment:**
 - **Action & Disposition:** Motion to recess approved by Roll Call (Commissioner Reett: yes, Commissioner Henry: yes). Meeting recessed.